favourite phrases, this series would be one to look back on, over a bottle of red, in ten years' time. I had never beaten them but had come to admire them as opponents, and men, as eras shifted. I took a few lumps facing Graeme Smith's team, which featured the likes of Jacques Kallis, my mate Mark Boucher, Makhaya Ntini, Dale Steyn and Vernon Philander. Shaun Pollock has an awesome record in both forms of the game, as bowler and catcher, yet is one of the most underrated modern cricketers.

Morne Morkel, a really nice guy, caused me a lot of grief down the years. He was probably at his peak as a bowler when he retired from international cricket in the spring of 2018. Tall and quick without being an absolute rocket, his natural shape, angling it in, was awkward for left-handers. He had tended to bowl half a yard too short, but once he picked up the knack of finding the perfect length for challenging the top of the off stumps, he was hard, hard work.

Graeme Smith assumed the captaincy early in his career, at the age of twenty-two, and played with edge and acceptable arrogance until his retirement in 2014. He failed to walk when Ryan Sidebottom claimed for caught behind, following Smith's huge drive in the fourth Test at the Wanderers in January 2010. There was an obvious noise; if that happens when the batsman is playing well away from his body, he has almost certainly hit it.

On-field umpire Tony Hill disagreed. Since we were playing without the Hotspot technical aid, and operating an early version of DRS, Andrew Strauss immediately referred it to Daryl Harper, the third umpire, who upheld the decision. Smith, unbeaten on 15, went on to make 105. South Africa won the match by an innings and squared the series. We were convinced Harper's monitor hadn't had the sound turned on.

When we flew home the following evening the British Airways pilot, a member of the Barmy Army, woke us as we were preparing for descent into London. After the usual preamble, hoping we had enjoyed the overnight flight, he added, 'You'll be pleased to know that Daryl Harper's ejector seat worked perfectly over the equator.' Predawn laughter echoed down the plane.

Seven months later, after an investigation into three complaints by the ECB, Harper was cleared by the ICC of failing 'to make proper use of new technology'. The sound feed provided by the host broadcaster SABC was